

Whatever your age, now is the best time to plan for retirement, as the financial decisions you make today hold the key to the future that you have to live in

BUILDING A NEST EGG

Retirement: when you do not have to set the alarm clock every morning, drag yourself out of bed and into the office. When you can spend your days doing exactly what you love – travel, walk the dog, grow roses... Sadly, most people actually think of retirement with some discomfort mostly because of financial reasons. You can avoid this fear by asking yourself some very basic questions today like: Do I have a sufficient amount saved up to see me through my sunset years? Can I maintain my present lifestyle even when I stop working? Can I be sure I won't outlive my savings?

These are very relevant questions, especially today, when advances in medicine and health care mean that your life-span is higher than it would have been even 15 years ago. These worries are compounded by the fact that there's no social security, which means you have to fend for yourself even when you're old and grey. Apart from that, there's inflation. Put simply, inflation diminishes the purchasing power of your rupee, which means that over time, you will pay more for the same goods. Add to all of this the rising cost of medical care, and you have a long list of very compelling reasons to save for your retirement.

In an ideal world, you start planning and saving for your retirement from the

Are You Ready?



WHEN WOULD YOU LIKE TO RETIRE?

WHAT TYPE OF LIFESTYLE ARE YOU PLANNING?

HOW MUCH WILL YOU NEED TO LIVE THAT WAY?

WHAT ARE THE POTENTIAL SOURCES OF THAT INCOME (PENSION, ANNUITY, SAVINGS, HOUSE RENT)?

WHAT EFFECT WILL INFLATION HAVE ON YOUR RETIREMENT?

HOW MANY YEARS DO YOU HAVE LEFT TO SAVE FOR RETIREMENT?

day you get your first salary. In the real world, however, this rarely happens. Children and family are still considered better retirement plans than a large nest egg. Which is not a practical solution in this age of nuclear families.

Saving and investing for retirement is something that needs to be started as early as possible. That's because the longer you accumulate funds, the more you allow the power of compounding to work on increasing your money.

It's now possible to put a number to how much each person needs to live a comfortable retired life. However, there are some standard ways of arriving at this amount. The simplest form is to work out your monthly household expenses, account for inflation and the number of years you assume you will live post-retirement.

Some experts will have more complicated and thorough ways of arriving at this number, but this simple method at least allows you to begin thinking seriously of how you should save for retirement. Once you start the process, you can review the exercise, make course corrections where needed and take stock regularly.

Although your retirement may be years away, your planning for it shouldn't be. At the risk of being repetitive, we will say this: the younger you start, the more the benefits in your favour.

Every retirement dream has a **NUMBER**.

Plan your **NUMBER** with us.

Retirement
Solutions

SMS 'NUMBER' TO 57827*

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